

Switzerland Train Trip — September 2026

Route: Barcelona → Geneva → Montreux → Luzern → Bern → Lugano → Milan → Torino → Barcelona

Duration: 7 nights / 8 days (Sep 11–18, 2026)

Itinerary

Day	Date	Weekday	From → To	Transport	Highlights
1	Sep 11	Thursday	Barcelona → Geneva	TGV/AVE via Lyon (~5.5h)	Arrive, Jet d'Eau, Old Town
2	Sep 12	Friday	Geneva	—	CERN (book ahead), Old Town
3	Sep 13	Saturday	Geneva → Montreux → Luzern	Regional (1h) + GoldenPass (~5h)	Château de Chillon stop, Alpine meadows
4	Sep 14	Sunday	Luzern	—	Chapel Bridge, Lake, Mt. Pilatus
5	Sep 15	Monday	Luzern → Bern	Regional (~1h)	Zytglogge, Bear Park, Federal Palace
6	Sep 16	Tuesday	Bern → Luzern → Lugano → Milan	Regional (1h) + Gotthard Panorama (~5.5h) + Regional (1h)	Lake Luzern boat + Gotthard pass
7	Sep 17	Wednesday	Milan → Torino	Regional (~1h)	Egyptian Museum, Mole Antonelliana
8	Sep 18	Thursday	Torino → Barcelona	Via Lyon (~8h) or coastal via Nice (~10h)	—

Route Map

Travel Times

All times approximate — verify at [sbb.ch](https://www.sbb.ch) / [renfe.com](https://www.renfe.com) / [raileurope.com](https://www.raileurope.com)

Leg	Date	Dep	Arr	Duration	Train
Barcelona → Geneva	Sep 11 Thu	≈08:00	≈13:30	5.5h	TGV/AVE via Lyon
Geneva → Montreux	Sep 13 Sat	≈08:30	≈09:30	1h	Regional
Montreux → Luzern	Sep 13 Sat	≈11:00	≈16:00	5h	GoldenPass [scenic]
Luzern → Bern	Sep 15 Mon	≈09:00	≈10:00	1h	Regional
Bern → Luzern	Sep 16 Tue	≈07:30	≈08:30	1h	Regional

Leg	Date	Dep	Arr	Duration	Train
Luzern → Lugano	Sep 16 Tue	≈09:12	≈14:30	5.5h	Gotthard Panorama [scenic]
Lugano → Milan	Sep 16 Tue	≈15:00	≈16:00	1h	Regional
Milan → Torino	Sep 17 Wed	≈08:30	≈09:30	1h	Regional
Torino → Barcelona	Sep 18 Thu	≈07:00	≈15:00–17:00	8–10h	Via Lyon or coastal

Scenic Trains

Train	Leg	Duration	Notes
GoldenPass Panoramic	Montreux → Luzern	~5h	Via Zweisimmen, Interlaken
Gotthard Panorama Express	Luzern → Lugano	~5.5h	Boat on Lake Luzern + mountain train

Book in Advance

- **CERN tours** — home.cern/visits (fills up weeks ahead)
- **GoldenPass panoramic seats** — ~CHF 12 reservation fee
- **Gotthard Panorama Express seats** — popular in September
- **Barcelona → Geneva TGV** — cheaper when booked early

Return Options (Day 8)

- **Via Lyon** (faster, ~8h): Torino → Chambéry → Lyon → Barcelona
- **Via coast** (scenic, ~10–11h): Torino → Genova → Nice → Marseille → Barcelona

Pass Options

- **Swiss Travel Pass (6 consecutive days)** covers Sep 13–18 Swiss legs including scenic trains (minus small seat reservations)
- **Eurail Global Pass** for the full trip including Barcelona–Geneva and Torino–Barcelona legs

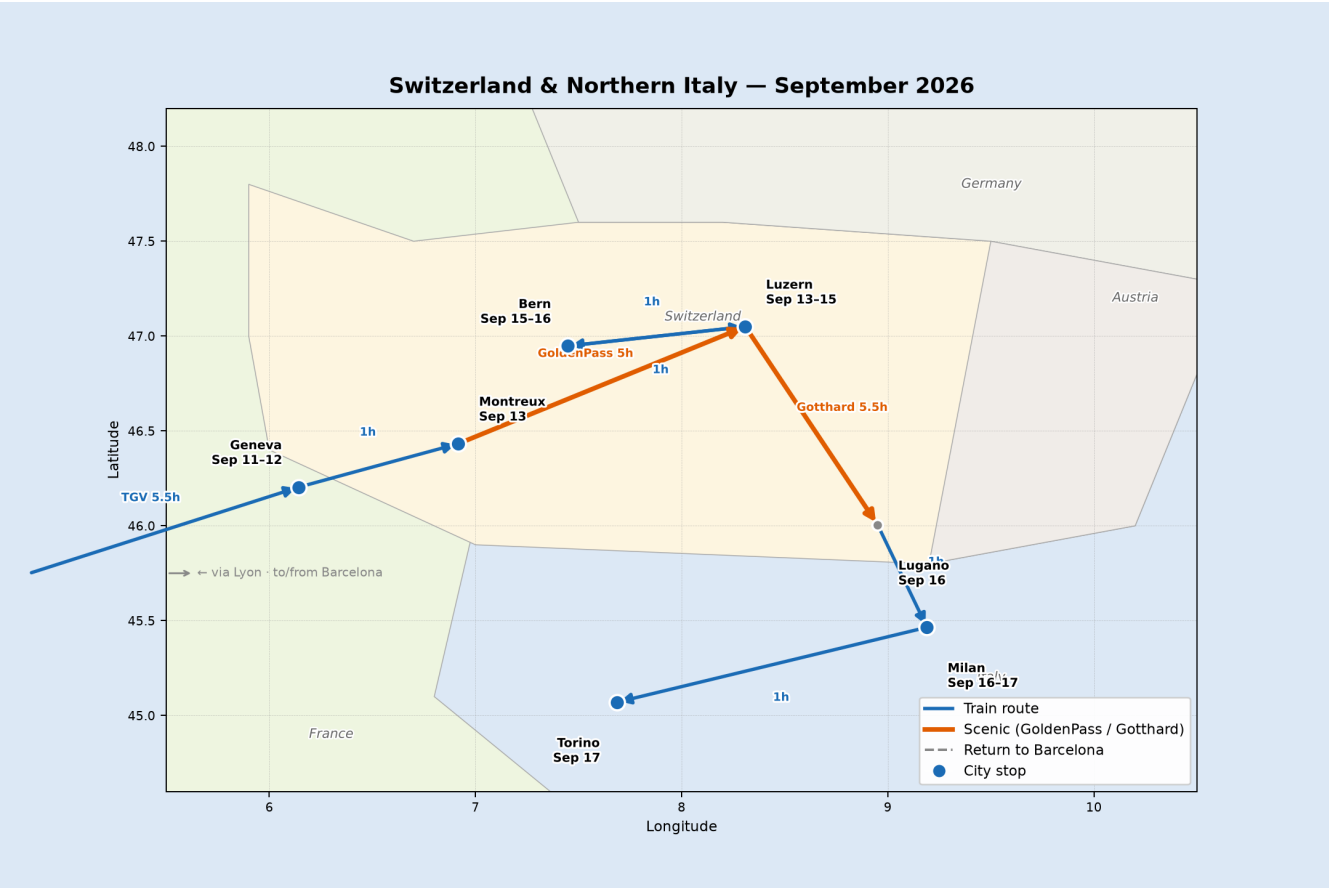


Figure 1: Geographic Route Map

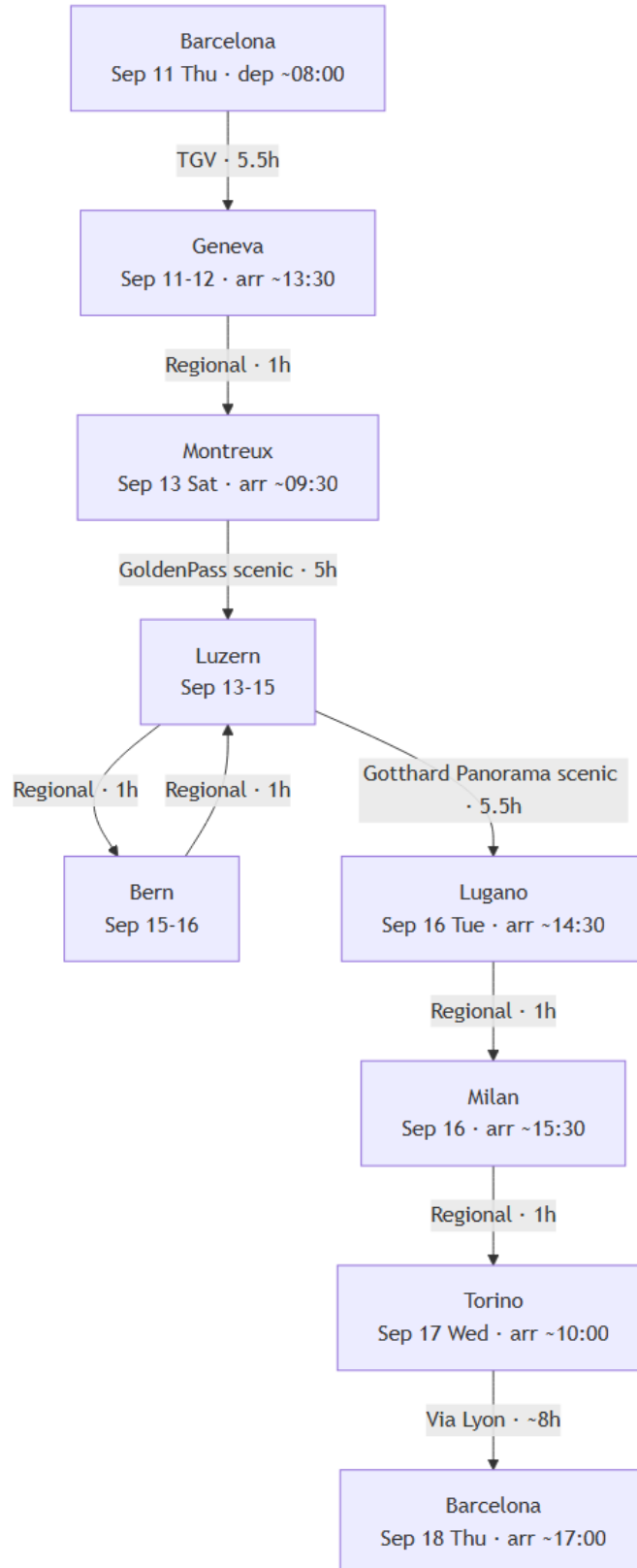


Figure 2: Route Flowchart